

## MEETINGS

# A meeting exists to decide and to build together.

How to cut meetings without losing alignment.

## AND THE CONSEQUENCE

Everything else is a mechanism that went missing.

## THE CASCADE

# How the calendar clogs up.

## WHAT YOU SEE

**A visible number is missing, so someone books a recurring slot...**

## THE MECHANISM

**...so nobody feels excluded, they invite twelve people...**

## THE CONSEQUENCE

**...and the meeting becomes scenery, no agenda and no decision.**

Every recurring meeting was born to patch a management hole.  
The hole is still there.

## THE FORK

# A meeting only earns its place like this.

## WHEN IT EARNs IT

01

Is there a decision to come out of it? Keep it.

02

Does it need joint building or a sensitive talk? Keep it.

03

Is it only a status update? That is text, not a meeting.

If nobody has to answer in real time, it does not need people together.

## THE METHOD

# The meeting swap chart.



## 01 STATUS

becomes a visible number, updated without anyone asking

## 02 UPDATE

becomes short async text, with a named reader and a time

## 03 ALIGNMENT

becomes written accountability, who answers for what

## 04 DECISION

stays a meeting, with an agenda, an owner and thirty minutes

Three of the four types leave the calendar. The fourth gets shorter.

IN PRACTICE, IN ORDER

# Four rules that shorten any meeting.

01 • STATUS

## Agenda and material in advance, always.

with no material sent, the meeting is cancelled, no exceptions

02 • UPDATE

## One owner, not a committee.

whoever calls it owns the decision that comes out of it

03 • ALIGNMENT

## Only whoever decides or executes.

the rest get the summary, and nobody minds after two weeks

04 • DECISION

## Thirty minutes by default.

whoever needs an hour justifies it, and almost never can

TWO MODELS

# Alignment by meeting or by mechanism.

THE COMMON MODEL

## By meeting

- Everyone repeats what they already know
- Twelve people listening, two talking
- The decision waits for next time
- The week disappears in one hour blocks

THE DESIGNED MODEL

## By mechanism

- A number and text do the updating
- Only the deciders sit together
- A decision comes out with owner and date
- The week has room for actual work

## MISTAKE AND CONSEQUENCE

# Three habits that fill the calendar.

## 01 Booking a meeting to spread the accountability.

- a group decision with no owner is a decision nobody defends.

## 02 Inviting people as political insurance.

- each extra guest doubles the time and halves the sharpness.

## 03 Letting the recurring slot run on inertia.

- nobody cancels it because nobody feels like its owner.

Meeting time is productive time you are taking from someone else.

## THE CHAIN

# The one line minutes test.

01

**On the way out, write the decision in one line, with owner and date.**



02

**Cannot write anything?**



03

**Then the meeting did not need to exist, and neither do the next ones.**



WHERE LEADERSHIP STEPS IN

**Do this for two weeks and your calendar cleans itself.**

RUN IT THIS WAY NEXT TIME

# One hour to unclog the week.



## STEP 01

**List the recurring meetings and sort them into the four types.**

status, update,  
alignment or decision



## STEP 02

**Replace one of them with a visible number or short text.**

start with the most  
expensive one,  
headcount times  
duration



## STEP 03

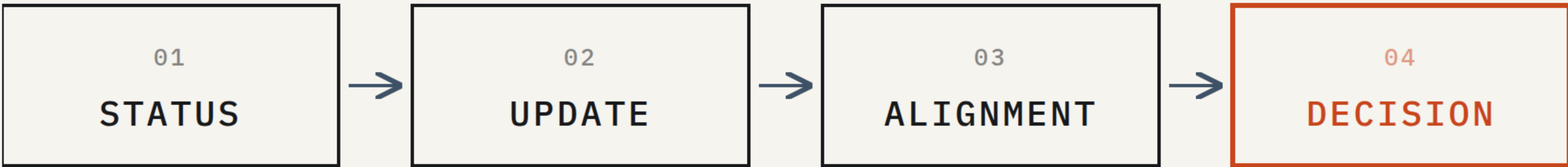
**Adopt the one line minutes in everything that survived.**

decision, owner and date,  
sent the same day

Cutting meetings is management work, not calendar trimming.

THE MODEL THAT STICKS

# The Meeting Swap, in the order that matters.



Alignment does not come from the number of meetings. It comes from clarity about who answers for what.

SAVE THIS FOR LATER

next time you are about to book a recurring meeting.

**FABIO GARCIA**

MANAGEMENT AS ENGINEERING  
/IN/FALERCIA